

Shadows

Drop shadows are enabled by the box-shadow property. Like rounded corners, drop shadows in Internet Explorer 9 are very robust; there are several options you can specify. The order of values within the box-shadow property is as follows:

```
box-shadow: hoffset voffset blur distance color inset;
```

- ▶ **hoffset** indicates the horizontal offset. This length value is required. It specifies how far to the right (positive value) or left (negative value) the shadow extends. See the following diagram for a visual explanation; hoffset is set to 20 pixels.
- ▶ **voffset** indicates the vertical offset. This length value is required. It specifies how far down (positive value) or up (negative value) the shadow extends. **voffset** 20 pixels.
- ▶ **blur** indicates the blur distance. This positive length value indicates how blurred the shadow's edge is – the approximate length between the start of the blur and the end. The higher the value, the more blurred it is. **blur** is set to 30 pixels.
- ▶ **distance** indicates the spread distance. This length value indicates how much the shadow shape expands in all directions (positive value) or contracts (negative value). Beyond the dimensions of the original shape **distance** is set to 30 pixels. The original offset border box shape is shown with a dotted line so you can better visualize the spread, which begins at the original offset box border.
- ▶ **color** indicates the color of the shadow.
- ▶ **inset** indicates the shadow is an inner shadow instead of an outer shadow. The first two values are required for the property to work, and all values must be specified in the order listed. If a color is not specified, Internet Explorer 9 uses black as the shadow color.

